



12 CERAMIC POT



13 HELMET



14 GOLD COIN

Islamic Treasures

The craftsmanship of the caliphate period was stunning, with even the most everyday objects featuring intricate and highly distinctive designs, often bearing religious inscriptions. Many different materials were used, including wood, metal, and ceramics.

1 Stone figure, dating from the late 12th–early 13th century. 2 Glass beaker, dating from 9th–10th century. 3 Bronze incense burner, dating from the 12th century and fashioned by the artist Ja'far ibn Muhammad ibn 'Ali. 4 Tiraz (textile) fragment, dating from the 10th century, with a black ink and gold leaf inscription reading "In the name of God, the merciful, the compassionate." 5 Pendant from the Fatimid caliphate, which ruled over North Africa, Egypt, and Syria. It is a mixture of gold and enamel and dates from the 11th century. 6 Enamel bowl from Persia (Iran), dating from the late 12th–early 13th century, with the words "good wishes" inscribed upon it. 7 Frieze tile c. 1270–80, using abstract floral and leaflike patterns. 8 Qur'an stand, dating to 1360, and made from carved and inlaid wood. 9 Brazier in cast bronze, dating from the second half of the 13th century, and dedicated to the Sultan al-Muzaffar ibn Umar. 10 Brass Seljuk ewer, c. 1180–1210, with inlaid silver and bitumen, and inscribed with the words "Glory,

prosperity, power, joy, happiness, permanent stability." 11 Brass alam, or standard, as carried in the annual Muharram ceremony, which commemorates the martyrdom of the grandson of the Prophet Muhammad, who died at the Battle of Karbala in 680 CE. 12 Ceramic pot dating from the second half of the 11th century and designed to hold medicine. 13 Persian military helmet, dating from the late 15th century and fashioned from iron and silver. 14 Gold dinar coin from Sicily. Struck during the reign of the Fatimid caliph al-Mustansir in the 11th century; the radiating lines on the piece are characteristic of the period. 15 Mosaic mihrab, dating from 1354. These niches are placed in mosques to indicate the direction of Mecca, Islam's holiest city. 16 Glass bottle, dating from the late 13th century, and probably made in Syria. The enameled and gilded glass features images of warriors wielding maces, swords, lances, and bows and arrows. 17 Gold armlet, dating from 1030 CE and made in Persia.



9 BRAZIER



10 SELJUK EWER



11 ALAM



15 MOSAIC MIHRAB



16 GLASS BOTTLE



17 METAL ARMLET